SALES PERFORMANCE & PROFITABILITY ANALYSIS

Executive Brief | Simulated Ghanaian Retail Business | Microsoft Excel

Purpose

Demonstrate how an analyst can turn retail transaction data into management insights using Excel. The dataset is synthetic and does not represent an actual company.

Illustrative headline metrics

Metric	Simulated result
Unique transactions	1,200
Net sales	GHS 580,113.75
Estimated contribution	GHS 224,439.06
Contribution margin	38.7%

Key illustrative findings

• Highest-sales month: 2025-10 (GHS 59,436.25).

• Lowest-sales month: 2025-04 (GHS 36,937.75).

• Highest estimated contribution category: Footwear (GHS 126,045.26).

• Lowest contribution margin category: Home & Lifestyle (37.2%).

• Highest estimated contribution region: Greater Accra (GHS 91,312.57).

Recommended management actions to test

• Investigate low-margin categories through pricing, supplier costs, discounting and delivery expenses.

• Track contribution margin alongside sales volume and revenue.

• Review seasonal peaks and troughs against stock availability, promotions and customer activity.

• Use a monthly data-quality checklist for duplicates, missing values, nonpositive quantities and unusual discounts.

• Assign action owners and due dates to dashboard findings, then measure results in the next review.

Method and limitations

Net sales = quantity × unit price × (1 – discount rate). Estimated contribution = net sales – product cost – delivery cost. Contribution is not accounting profit because overheads, taxes, returns, marketing and other costs are excluded. The dataset is synthetic; findings must not be represented as real-world business results. Relationships do not prove causation.

Portfolio use: pair this brief with the Excel workbook and be prepared to explain the data cleaning decisions, KPI definitions, findings, assumptions and recommended next steps.